

Executive Summary

Digital Banking Customer Adoption & Channel Migration Analytics

Turkey, 2021–2025

Selected Peer Group: Garanti BBVA, Akbank, İşbank

1. Project Objective

This project analyzes the evolution of digital banking adoption in Turkey between 2021 and 2025. The study combines sector-level statistics from the Banks Association of Turkey (TBB) with bank-level public disclosures from Garanti BBVA, Akbank and İşbank.

The core analytical question is:

How did digital banking customer adoption evolve in Turkey, and how did selected major banks scale digital customer relationships relative to their physical branch networks?

The project focuses on four analytical dimensions:

- sector-level mobile-first digital banking adoption,
- bank-level digital customer growth,
- branch-to-digital efficiency,
- directional digital adoption benchmarking.

2. Data Sources and Scope

The analysis covers the 2021–2025 period and uses publicly available data.

Data Layer		Source and Usage
Sector-level banking	digital	TBB Digital, Internet and Mobile Banking Statistics; used to analyze active digital banking customer records, mobile-only usage, internet-only usage and channel mix.
Bank-level disclosures	disclosures	Annual reports, integrated annual reports, investor presentations and offering circulars from Garanti BBVA, Akbank and İşbank.
Core benchmark metrics		Reported customer base, reported digital customers/users, branches, employees, ATMs, digital penetration and branch-to-digital efficiency indicators.
Supporting indicators		Mobile/app users, POS data, non-branch transaction ratios, mobile transaction indicators and selected digital channel engagement metrics.

The peer group was limited to Garanti BBVA, Akbank and İşbank to maintain consistency with the existing financial peer analysis project and to focus on banks with sufficient public digital banking disclosures.

3. Methodology

The project separates indicators into two groups: **core benchmark metrics** and **supporting indicators**.

Core benchmark metrics are used for cross-bank comparison and the Digital Adoption Index. These metrics are more consistently available across the selected banks:

- reported digital customers/users,
- reported customer base,
- reported digital penetration,
- branches, employees and ATMs,
- digital customers per branch,

- digital customers per employee,
- digital customer growth.

Supporting indicators are used for qualitative and bank-specific interpretation, but excluded from the core index because their definitions are not consistently disclosed across all banks:

- mobile banking customers / İşCep users / mobile transaction indicators,
- POS devices,
- non-branch transaction ratios,
- digital sales indicators,
- ecosystem metrics such as Nays or Maximum Mobile users.

This separation is important because banks do not report all digital banking indicators under a fully standardized taxonomy. For example, Garanti BBVA reports mobile banking customers, İşbank reports İşCep users, while Akbank does not consistently disclose a comparable mobile banking customer count for the full 2021–2025 period.

4. Core KPI Framework

The main KPIs used in the analysis are:

KPI	Formula	Business Meaning
Reported digital penetration	Digital customers / Reported customer base	Indicates the share of the reported customer base using digital banking channels.
Digital customers per branch	Digital customers / Branches	Measures how much digital customer scale is supported relative to the physical branch network.
Digital customers per employee	Digital customers / Employees	Directional operational efficiency proxy; not a full productivity measure.
Digital customer growth	$\frac{2025 \text{ digital customers}}{2021 \text{ digital customers}} - 1$	Measures digital customer scale expansion over the analysis period.
Branch-to-digital decoupling	$\frac{\text{Digital customer growth}}{\text{Branch growth}}$	Shows whether digital customer scale is growing independently of branch network expansion.

5. Sector-Level Findings: Mobile-First Banking

TBB data shows a clear mobile-first transformation in Turkish digital banking between 2021 and 2025.

Year	Total Active Digital Customers (M)	Only Mobile Share	Only Internet Share	Both Channel Share
2021	77.9	84.6%	3.5%	11.8%
2022	94.4	87.2%	2.4%	10.4%
2023	110.6	89.1%	1.6%	9.3%
2024	119.1	92.0%	1.1%	6.8%
2025	127.7	93.8%	0.8%	5.3%

Between 2021 and 2025, total active digital banking customer records increased from 77.9 million to 127.7 million. Over the same period, the mobile-only share increased from 84.6% to 93.8%, while the internet-only share declined from 3.5% to 0.8%.

Interpretation: Turkey’s digital banking structure is now structurally mobile-first. Internet banking remains relevant, but the primary digital adoption engine is clearly mobile banking.

6. Selected Bank Findings

Garanti BBVA

Garanti BBVA has the highest reported digital customer scale among the selected banks in 2025. Reported digital banking customers increased from 11.0 million in 2021 to 18.0 million in 2025.

Key implications:

- Garanti BBVA demonstrates strong digital customer scale.
- Digital banking customers grew faster than the reported customer base over the period.
- Mobile banking customers are almost equal to digital banking customers, supporting a mature mobile-first structure.

Akbank

Akbank's digital banking users doubled from 6.6 million in 2021 to 13.2 million in 2025. Over the same period, branches declined from 711 to 647.

Key implications:

- Akbank shows the strongest digital customer growth in the selected peer group.
- Reported digital penetration increased sharply, reaching approximately 87% in 2025.
- Digital users per branch increased from approximately 9.3 thousand to 20.4 thousand, indicating strong digital scaling against a smaller branch network.

İşbank

İşbank's digital banking customers increased from 10.2 million in 2021 to 16.2 million in 2025. Domestic branches declined from 1,174 to 997.

Key implications:

- İşbank has a large digital banking customer base and a strong İşÇep user base.
- Non-branch transaction ratio remained around 96.5–97%, indicating mature digital channel usage.
- İşbank scores lower in the core Digital Adoption Index because its digital customers per branch and 2021–2025 growth rate are lower than selected peers; however, supporting indicators suggest strong digital channel maturity.

7. 2025 Selected Bank Benchmark

Bank	Customer Base (M)	Digital Customers (M)	Digital Penetration	Branches	Digital Customers / Branch
Garanti BBVA	30.1	18.0	59.9%	795	22,693
Akbank	15.2	13.2	86.8%	647	20,402
İşbank	25.5	16.2	63.5%	997	16,249

Interpretation: Garanti BBVA leads in absolute reported digital customer scale, Akbank leads in reported digital penetration, and İşbank maintains a large digital base with strong supporting channel indicators.

8. Digital Adoption Index

A directional Digital Adoption Index was developed to compare selected banks using more comparable core metrics.

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{Digital Adoption Index} = & 0.30 \times \text{Digital Penetration Score} \\
& + 0.30 \times \text{Digital Customers per Branch Score} \\
& + 0.20 \times \text{Digital Customers per Employee Score} \\
& + 0.20 \times \text{Digital Customer Growth Score}
\end{aligned}$$

The index is based on min-max normalized scores across the selected peer group.

Important note: This index is a project-specific directional framework based on selected public indicators. It is not an official, regulatory or comprehensive digital maturity ranking.

The index should be interpreted as a structured analytical comparison of core public metrics, not as a definitive statement of which bank is “the most digital.”

9. Strategic Recommendations

Based on the analysis, five strategic recommendations emerge:

1. **Treat mobile-first banking as the sector baseline.** TBB data shows that mobile-only usage dominates digital banking adoption in Turkey.
2. **Track digital customers per branch as a channel efficiency KPI.** This metric helps evaluate how digital scale grows relative to the physical network.
3. **Reposition branches toward advisory and complex services.** As routine transactions migrate to digital channels, branches should focus more on higher-value interactions.
4. **Use mobile channels for engagement, retention and cross-sell.** Mobile banking is not only an access channel but also a primary relationship channel.
5. **Separate comparable KPIs from supporting indicators.** Banks should not be compared on mobile/app or POS metrics without checking definition consistency.

10. Limitations

The analysis has several limitations:

- TBB data is sector-level and not bank-level.
- Bank-level data is based on public disclosures and may not follow fully standardized definitions.
- Garanti BBVA, Akbank and İşbank use different wording such as digital customers, digital users and İşCep users.
- Akbank does not consistently disclose mobile banking customer count for the full 2021–2025 period.
- POS data is excluded from the core benchmark due to inconsistent definitions.
- İşbank 2025 data is based on 4Q25 investor presentation and 2026 Offering Circular because the 2025 annual report was not available at the time of data collection.
- The Digital Adoption Index is directional and project-specific.

11. Conclusion

The analysis indicates that Turkish digital banking became strongly mobile-first between 2021 and 2025. At the bank level, Garanti BBVA, Akbank and İşbank all expanded their digital customer bases while physical branch networks either declined or remained constrained.

The strongest analytical message is not simply that digital customers increased. The more important finding is that digital customer scale expanded relative to branch networks, supporting a clear branch-to-digital efficiency narrative.

This project demonstrates how public banking disclosures can be transformed into a structured analytics framework covering sector trends, peer benchmarking, KPI design, methodology discipline and strategic recommendations.